SAPTASHYA GHOSH

Indian School of Business
Hyderabad
INDIA

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EDUCATION

Shiv Nadar University, Institution of Eminence, Delhi NCR **August 2021 - May 2023**
M.S. in Economics

- CGPA 8.53/10.0 (Rank 1 in cohort)
- Thesis: *Do Political Cycles Alarm Officers? Evidence from the Indian Bureaucracy*
  Advisor: Arka Roy Chaudhuri

Scottish Church College, University of Calcutta, Kolkata **June 2018 - July 2021**
B.Sc. (Hons.) in Economics, Minor in Mathematics and Statistics

- CGPA 8.61/10.0

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconomics, Econometrics, Structural Modelling

Topics: Digital Attention and Consumer Behaviour, Firm Competition, Social Welfare Analysis

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

1. Indian School of Business (Hyderabad) - *Pranav Jindal and Saharsh Agarwal*
Research Associate, June 2025 - present

- Modelled digital addiction using a multiple discrete-continuous (MDCEV) model of app-time allocation with a Becker-Murphy habit stock. Derived its reduced form and estimated it using user-app-level panel data.
- Built a session-level smartphone usage panel using raw app-session records of over one million Android users in India, and used it to conduct causal and structural analysis.
- Conducted a natural experiment using the government ban of Battlegrounds Mobile India (BGMI) of July 2022 and studied digital habits at the app or category level to understand the level of digital addiction.
- Constructed concentration and diversity measures of digital attention (Herfindahl-Hirschman index, Shannon entropy) to quantify how LLM adoption reshapes app usage.
- Estimated the effects of LLM app adoption on smartphone usage using staggered difference-in-differences and event-study designs, conducted robustness checks and written and edited the research manuscript for journal submission.
- Conducted literature reviews on addiction, state dependence, misinformation, changes in technology policy and related consumer preferences.
- Presented papers in research reading groups from Economics, Marketing and Information Systems journals.

2. Centre for Advanced Financial Research and Learning (CAFRAL), Reserve Bank of India

(Mumbai)

Research Associate, July 2023 - May 2025

- Used firm-level, consumer-level and bank transaction-level data, and other proprietary data such as UPI transactions and CIBIL data, and microdata from CMIE Prowess and CPHS to conduct analysis on UPI exposure and consumer expenditure patterns.
- Studied the effect of climate hazards such as heat shock and their consequences for household expenditure and commodity prices; contributed a chapter to the *India Finance Report 2025*.
- Assembled large datasets on heat stress, floods, droughts and agricultural prices through web scraping and geospatial processing.
- Presented at reading groups and attended brown-bag seminars.

3. Ashoka University and IIT Kanpur, Joint Project (Hybrid)

Research Assistant, February 2023 - June 2023

- Applied microeconomics research using the Annual Survey of Industries (ASI), India Human Development Survey (IHDS) and RBI data; estimated event-study and DiD specifications.

PUBLICATIONS

- Saptashya Ghosh and Sankalp Mathur (2025), "Weathering the Storm: Climate Change and Household Finance in India", Chapter 4, *India Finance Report 2025*, Centre for Advanced Financial Research and Learning (CAFRAL), Reserve Bank of India

WORKING PAPERS

- **AI at the Fingertips: How Does LLM App Adoption Reshape Smartphone Usage?**, Submitted, *Information Systems Research*

  Saptashya Ghosh, Saharsh Agarwal

WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Saptashya Ghosh, Pranav Jindal and Saharsh Agarwal, Where Does Digital Addiction Reside? App Versus Category-Level Habit Formation: Evidence From a Mobile Game Ban**

  Saptashya Ghosh, Pranav Jindal, Saharsh Agarwal

PHD COURSES TAKEN (ISB)

- Marketing, Public Policy and Economic Development (Ongoing) — *Pradeep K. Chintagunta*
- Theory of Information Economics (*Grade: A*) — *Ram N. V. Ramanan*
- Real Analysis (*Grade: A-*) — *Sabareesh Ramachandran*
- Linear Algebra (*Grade: A-*) — *Anand Deo*

OTHER RELEVANT COURSES TAKEN

Post Graduate: Microeconomics I, Microeconomics II, Mathematical Methods, Econometrics I, Econometrics II, Statistics
Under Graduate: Differential and Integral Calculus, Linear Algebra ,Differential Equation, Coordinate Geometry, Numerical Methods, Linear Programming, Applications of Statistics, Applied Econometrics

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Shiv Nadar University, Department of Economics
Teaching Assistant

- Macroeconomics II (Postgraduate) - Spring 2023
- Money and Banking (Undergraduate) - Monsoon 2022
- Introduction to Microeconomics (Undergraduate) - Spring 2022
- Game Theory (Undergraduate) - Monsoon 2021

PRESENTATIONS

"AI at the Fingertips: How Does LLM App Adoption Reshape Smartphone Usage?"

- ISB–Deakin Conference 2025, Hyderabad

ACHIEVEMENTS AND AWARDS

- Student Fellowship and Teaching Assistantship, Shiv Nadar University, 2021 - 2023
- Best Student Award, Scottish Church College, University of Calcutta, 2020

SKILLS

Software: R, Stata, Python, LaTeX; QGIS (intermediate)
Languages: English, Bengali (native); Hindi (fluent)

REFERENCES

Pranav Jindal
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